

Session 5: The Prophet to Come: The Seams of the Torah and Prophets

Key Takeaways

- The final sentences of the Torah and the opening sentences of the Prophets (“Seam One”) anticipate a coming Moses-like prophet who is promised but is yet to come.
- The final sentences of the Prophets and the opening sentences of the Ketuvim (“Seam Two”) anticipate a coming Elijah-like prophet who will call the people back to the Torah and restore the hearts of Israel to Yahweh.

The Seams of the TaNaK

Seam One

The final sentences of the Torah and opening sentences of the Prophets:

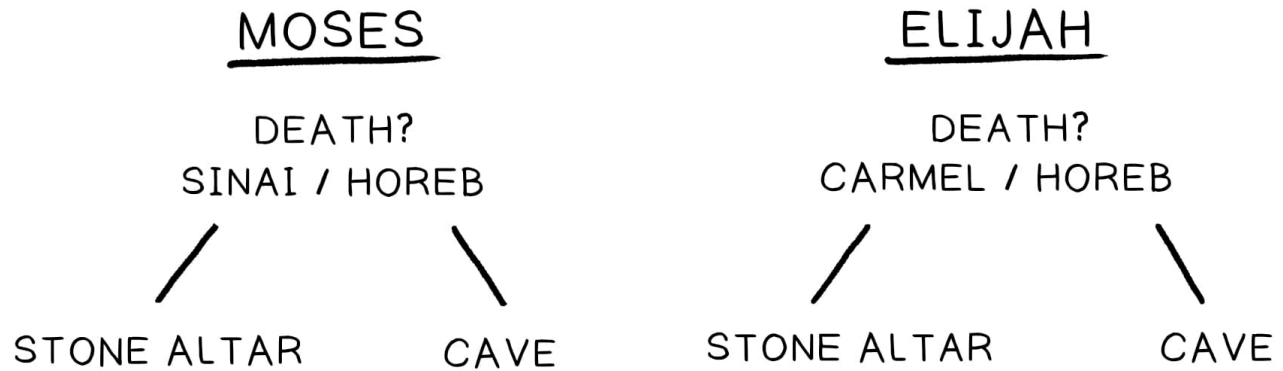
- **Deuteronomy 34:10-12**: Anticipation of a coming Moses-like prophet who was promised but never came.
- **Joshua 1:1-9**: God’s appointed leader Joshua, who will lead the people into the promised land, must meditate on the Torah day and night to find success.

Seam Two

The final sentences of the Prophets and the opening sentences of the Ketuvim:

- **Malachi 4:4-6**: Anticipation of a coming Elijah-like prophet who will call the people back to the Torah and restore the hearts of Israel before the Day of the Lord.
- **Psalms 1-2**: The righteous one who will be vindicated in the final judgment is one who meditates on the Torah day and night to find success (Ps. 1). This righteous one is the future messianic king from the line of David, who is appointed by God to rule the nations and overcome evil once and for all (Ps. 2).

SEAMS: THE TORAH & LATTER PROPHETS



TaNaK Seams: The Torah and Latter Prophets. Illustration created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Introduction to the Hebrew Bible (2019).

Structure Reveals Purpose

The seams of the TaNaK help illuminate what the authors and compilers of the Hebrew Bible intended as the purpose of this collection of writings.

The Hebrew Bible is meditation literature that is designed to foster:

- A lifetime practice of reading and pondering the meaning of these texts.
- Future hope in the promised prophet who will herald the arrival of the Day of the Lord and the messianic kingdom ([Deut. 34](#); [Mal. 4](#)).
- A covenantal way of life that creates a counterculture to the prevailing world systems ([Josh. 1](#); [Ps. 1](#)).

Reflection Question

The seams of the TaNaK describe the kind of leader humanity really needs. What do the Torah and Prophets say this person is like?